

Oceans

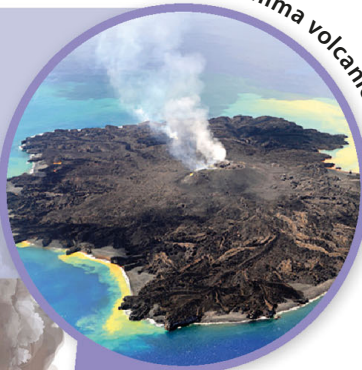
Around 71 per cent of the Earth's surface is covered by oceans. Many different and interesting features are found in and around them, and a huge variety of animals and plants have adapted to life in this watery world.



Pacific green turtle

Volcanic islands

These islands are formed from layers of magma, or hot liquid rock, which erupts from a volcano under the water, then cools and hardens. The magma layers eventually build up to create an island.



Nishinoshima volcanic island, Japan

Open ocean

This is the top layer of the ocean, nearest the surface. The open ocean is vast. Although food can sometimes be hard to find, many animals, such as dolphins, seals, and turtles, live there.

Oceanic trench

When tectonic plates in the ocean floor move and collide, one may be pushed under the other, creating a narrow trench. These trenches are the deepest places in the Earth's oceans.

Seamounts

These underwater mountains are formed by volcanic eruptions on the ocean floor. Most of them are not erupting.

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